Cetuximab + cisplatin + fluorouracil

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00417 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before the first visit

Bring your medicines and allergy list, test dates, treatment calendar and actual emergency contacts. Tell the unit about swallowing, hearing, mobility, transport or communication needs.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

Cetuximab starts with a 400 mg/m² loading dose over 120 minutes, then 250 mg/m² over 60 minutes weekly. Chemotherapy starts at least 1 hour after cetuximab finishes. Cisplatin 100 mg/m² is given over 2 hours on Day 1 with prescribed fluids before and after. Fluorouracil is 1,000 mg/m² over 22 hours daily on Days 1–4, or the alternative 2,000 mg/m² over 46–48 hours repeated on Days 3–4. Staff confirm the chosen pump schedule. Plan for monitoring during and for at least 1 hour after each cetuximab infusion under the current medicine information; confirm the observation plan with your unit.

STEP 3

Infusion and appointment planning

Daily 22-hour fluorouracil on Days 1–4, or 2,000 mg/m² over 46–48 hours twice as prescribed; confirm changes and completion.

STEP 4

Before you leave

Check the next treatment and test dates, medicines, pump or line appointments, and who to contact if unwell. Have the team replace and verify every example phone number on the wallet card.

STEP 5

Practical support

Ask about transport, work, costs, caring responsibilities, an interpreter or a support person. Keep changes to the plan in one record.

Sources: NCCP 00417 v7: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.